



Development Toolkit

For People Leaders

Table of contents

Use the squares below to jump to the topic you need. 

What's in this toolkit?

Development conversations

Your development

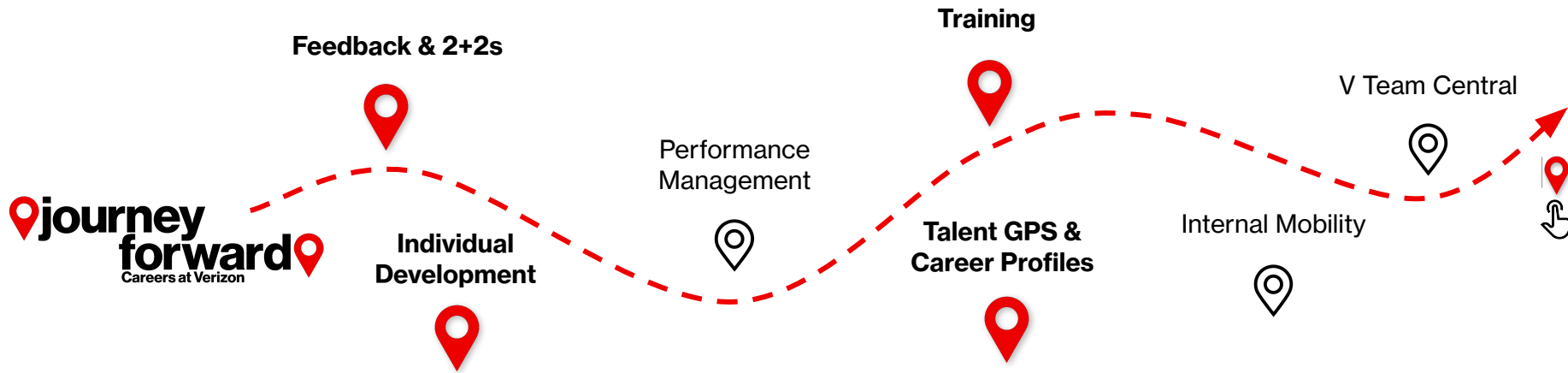
Continuous development

**Supporting development
planning**

**Feedback- the key to
continuous growth**

How to use this toolkit as part of your journey forward

Journey Forward encompasses all that Verizon offers to help build your career, track your performance and progress, and remain accountable. It's a connected constellation of resources and career drivers that empower and enable you to unlock your full potential, including:



This toolkit is part of how Verizon is supporting you, through Journey Forward, to plan for you and your team's development.

It will answer questions such as:

- How do I help my team set development goals?
- How do I have a development conversation with my employee?
- How can I leverage tools like Talent GPS, career profiles, and training to help my team with their development goals?
- How do I motivate my team to focus on development year round and continue to check in with them throughout the year?

Use this toolkit to make a plan, maximize your and your team's development and build skills.

Explore your possibilities on the My Career pages



My Career

My Career is your main hub for all development resources. You'll have quick and easy access to a constellation of resources including all the tools you need to have conversations about your performance, **learn something new, develop in your current role and get ready for your next adventure.**

V Team Principles

Our V Team Principles give you the guidance needed to effectively role model leadership in what you do and how you work every day.

Access this page to explore resources you can use to hold yourself accountable and continue to grow as a leader at Verizon.



My Development

Planning for your development supports your career both now and in the future.

Visit this page to access tools and resources to help you develop in your current role or learn something new.

Talent GPS

Navigating a career at Verizon – one that aligns with your unique interests, skills and aspirations – means harnessing your curiosity and sense of ownership.

Access this page to explore resources and planning tools that support your career journey.

Your development

Before we get into your role supporting your team...

It's important to focus on supporting your team's development but the best way to encourage your employees to learn and grow is to model it yourself!

That's why every year you'll have a goal to Model the V Team Principles. Modeling the V Team Principles is expected of all People Leaders here at Verizon and it's included in your performance goals. Although this is expected performance, we also encourage you to use the V Team Principles as a starting point for your development actions.

How can your development support achieving this goal?

We've provided some examples of how you can incorporate the V Team Principles into your Development Actions. Pay special attention to "Champion Growth". Going through this toolkit means you are on your way to building the skills needed to support your team. Use the V Team Principle self reflection tool linked here for more inspiration and to find your own blind spots.



V Team Principles Sample Accomplishments

Use these samples to help craft your development actions!

Be Customer Centric

Grow my customer service mindset by dedicating time each month to interact with my clients. Create a bank of questions to regularly ask during these interactions to get insights directly from customers as well as researching customer, competitor, and technology trends

Embrace Inclusion

We create inclusive environments because our strength as a company is based on the strength of the V Team. We seek diverse perspectives, listen and create safe, open environments where every individual can be and feel welcomed, respected, supported, and valued to fully participate.

Model Integrity

We hold ourselves accountable and always act with integrity. We don't take shortcuts or adopt a "win at all costs" mentality. We advocate for, adopt and demonstrate our Culture OS values of Trust, Care and Excellence.

Deliver Innovation

Build strength in delivering innovation by increasing my knowledge of design thinking and hosting sessions with my team to promote innovation and create new products or processes.

Activate Teamwork

Develop team leadership skills by intentionally recognizing team members for exemplifying their strengths while contributing to team goals.

Champion Growth

Champion growth of my team by bringing in an external speaker or new learning course/topic monthly to our staff calls.



Champion Growth



Definition: We support and root for one another as we learn and develop. We actively give, receive, and implement constructive feedback. We work to continuously grow and stretch beyond our current capabilities.

Executive Leaders	People Leaders	All V Teamers
Organizational Focus	Team Focus	Individual Focus
Develop a long-term personal learning plan in alignment with Verizon's strategic objectives	Build a personal development plan that includes challenging objectives aligned to your team's strategic priorities	Establish and pursue challenging development goals
Use established processes to generate insightful feedback that informs your career and personal development	Use established processes to generate insightful feedback that informs your career and personal development	Initiate career conversations with your manager and other leaders/mentors/advocates
Pursue opportunities to learn, using formal and informal resources	Pursue opportunities to learn, using formal and informal resources	Pursue opportunities to learn, using formal and informal resources
Build, foster, and champion a constructive feedback loop that promotes individual and team development	Engage in continuous upward and downward feedback process, and leverage metrics to promote individual and team development	Seek, share and implement feedback with a focus on growth

Developing as a leader



Developing your leadership skills is what will enable you to support your team as they embark on their own development journeys.

Refer to the Self Reflection section in the employee [Development Toolkit](#) to help identify your Leadership Development Focus Areas, and use these resources to get you started.

Leadership

Learning Plan - Leadership involves using strategies to enlist others in setting, embracing, and achieving objectives while having a long-term perspective of the future state of things and how to get there.

V Team Principles

Learning Plan - Prepare for success by focusing on your personal development. Use the plans on this page to set your learning journey and discover ways to continually improve your skills.

Inclusive Leadership

LinkedIn Learning - In this course, learn how to revamp your own leadership and communication practices to ensure that your team continues to thrive.

Supporting development planning

What part do you play in your team's development?



The coach, mentor, and advocate.

Although employees own their careers here at Verizon, you have the tools, resources, and connections that your team may need to progress on their journey. It will be your job to support your team and use your resources to help them achieve their goals.

What does that mean?

- **Listen** to what your employees express interest in.
- **Be prepared** to make recommendations on skills the employee might focus on to grow individually and support the team.
- **Think** about opportunities and projects that may fit their interests and goals.

A note for People Leaders of associate employees



Development actions are new for associates with the introduction of V Team Central. As a leader of associate employees, keep a few things in mind as you go through this toolkit:

- **Development Actions are not required** for associates but are a new tool for them to take ownership of their career at Verizon.
- **This is not the Performance Development Plan.** You will continue to create a performance development plan for your associate employee when you complete the Associate Goals and Development Plan document. Development Actions are created and owned by the employee.
- **Associates have a different toolkit** that only includes information relevant to them. Check out the [Development Toolkit for Associates here.](#)
 - Note that as you go through this People Leader toolkit you will see * and a note when a statement or process does not apply to associates.
- **The feedback functionality in V Team Central is not applicable to associates.** However, feedback as a skill is applicable to all! In the feedback section any content related to V Team Central will not be available for associates to request or for you to request for associate members of your team.
- **2+2 Conversations are not applicable to associates.** However, you should still be having frequent conversations about your employees progress towards their goals.

The difference between managing Performance and Development



Performance is how you fulfill your job responsibilities and meet the goals and expectations set in your Performance Goals. It refers to the effectiveness, and quality of your work and how your contribution connects to Verizon's culture, innovation and growth objectives.



Development is your opportunity to grow through continuous learning, including on-the-job learning, formal training, or other opportunities. The development actions you create set you up for opportunities and support your career now and in the future.

Managing Performance:

- Employee performance has direct impacts on personal, team and organizational success.
- You are ultimately responsible for the output of your team so managing performance is one of your top priorities.
- The performance goals you set with your employee should be specific to the strategic goals of your business.

Refer to the Performance Toolkits listed [here](#) for more information.

Supporting Development:

- Development is a key part of employee engagement and satisfaction
- Employee's own their development so you play a supporting role in setting development actions.
- Development actions can be related to skills and opportunity areas outside of an employees direct role.

Getting started

Before V teamers start creating their development actions, we suggest they do some self reflection.

In the [Development Toolkit](#) for employees we give the following options for reflection and development planning. **Click on each icon**  to learn how you can support your employee through the different reflection exercises.



Self Reflection Questions

Ask yourself these probing questions to identify your interests and areas of focus.



Gather Perspectives

Using the Feedback functionality in V Team Central, ask for input from a few trusted colleagues.



What to include: The W's

When crafting your development actions, make sure to answer these questions.



Making them SMART

Any goal you set should follow the SMART model. Learn more about setting SMART goals here.

Supporting self-reflection and setting a Point B



Self Reflection Questions

Answer the questions from the Development Toolkit for employees (below) with this employee in mind. Go through these questions during your development conversation.

- What do I aspire to do more of or try?
- How can I use my current performance goals as opportunities to grow?*
- How might I focus on the V Team Principles I identified in the worksheet?
- After choosing an area of focus, think about who you know that does this well? What or how do they do this that makes them stand out?
- Think about your top five Clifton Strengths, how might you use these more in your day-to-day?

*Performance goals are not related to development actions for associates.



Gather perspectives

Self reflection is always a great start to identifying those key development areas, but your peers have great perspectives as well!

To help your employees gather input, encourage your team to use the feedback tool* in V Team Central to get insights from trusted colleagues. You'll be able to see this feedback when it comes in and debrief it with your employee.

It's not always easy to get feedback. Make sure you are acting as a supportive coach when discussing feedback received with your employee. Check out the Feedback section in this toolkit for more tips.

*The feedback tool is not available for associates.

Supporting goal creation

Take out your checklist! Does the written Development Action have the following elements?



What to include: The W's

- ☐ Who will be involved?
- ☐ What will be achieved?
- ☐ When will it be completed?
- ☐ Where is it happening?
- ☐ Why is the skill being developed?



Setting SMART goals

- ☐ Specific
- ☐ Measurable
- ☐ Actionable
- ☐ Realistic
- ☐ Timebound

Development conversations

What is a development conversation?

As a leader, a development conversation is a discussion with your employee about their development which can include future opportunities or development and actions they can take in their current role.

The goal of a Development Conversation is to:

- Inspire and build future Verizon leaders.
- Enable employees to explore, grow and develop their knowledge and skills.
- Allow you to build and practice the Champion Growth V Team Principle by providing constructive feedback to help employees grow.
- Support retention, employee engagement and productivity.
 - 82% of employees said they would be more engaged if their manager had regular career conversations with them*.

* [Talk The Talk: How Ongoing Career Conversations Drive Business Success](#)

Why is engagement important?

Organizations with high engagement have:

2.5x greater revenue growth

2x annual net income

40% lower turnover

24% higher net promoter score

18% higher productivity

[Employee Engagement at Work: Definition & Examples](#)

How to talk about development with your team.



It's important to make sure our V teamers know that their leaders support their present and their future!

Having ongoing development conversations lets our employees know that we are invested in their career here at Verizon. Be sure to have ongoing conversations about your employees' development separate from your regular one-on-one's and make development an ongoing agenda item on your team calls.

We all know that actions speak louder than words, so aside from talking about development with your team, make sure you are modeling it. Think about sharing your own development actions with your employees or working on one development action together with your team.

Development conversations should happen year-round!

However, our yearly performance events are a great time to check in with your team on their Development Actions!

During Goal Setting

At Mid-Year

At Year-End

Before the conversation



- **Reflect.** Think about a time you had a particularly meaningful development conversation. What qualities made it so meaningful to you?
- **Explore** your employee's previous development actions and current performance goals.*
- **Review** the V Team Principles and, if your employee has completed and shared it, their V Team Principles Self Reflection and the "Discuss it" section of the Your Career Journey tool*.
- **Think** about the areas you would like to see your employee develop. Remember that your employee owns their development and may choose different development areas than you would. Let them lead the direction of the conversation and be prepared to share your thoughts.
- **Consider** the top priorities for your team, any upcoming special projects or initiatives, and what development opportunities may exist as a result.
- **Prepare** to ask probing questions and listen to the answers. These conversations are a great way to get to know your employees better and to ensure you are connecting them to challenging and engaging work.

*Development actions are not related to performance for associates.

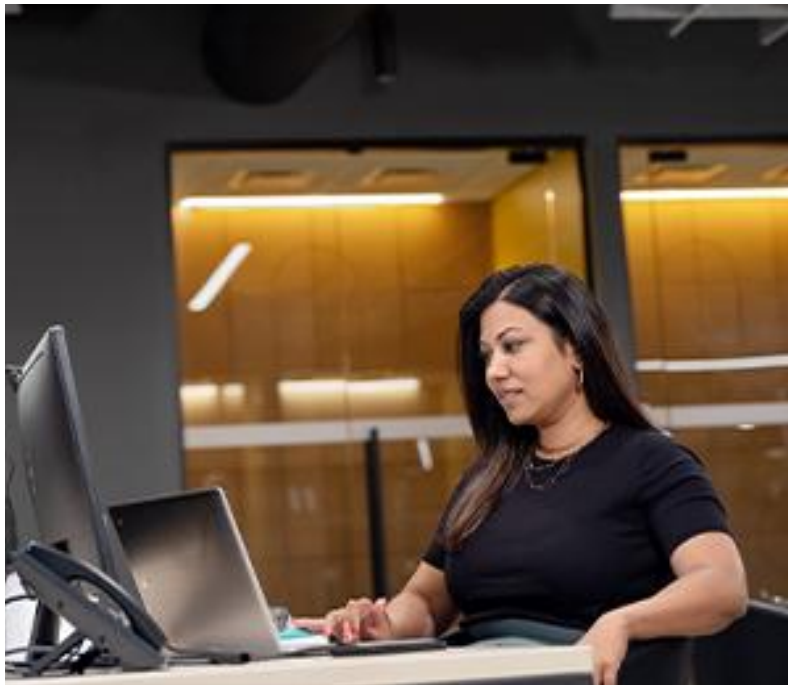
*Associates do not have access to the Your Career Journey tool

During the conversation

- Let your employee lead the discussion.
- Be a coach, mentor, and supporter.
- Ask probing questions.
- Discuss potential obstacles and make a plan for how to remove them.
- Talk about past successes and challenges.
- Discuss short and long term development goals.
- Identify development actions and opportunities that align with your employee's goals.
- Confirm next steps.



After the conversation



- Help your employee update their development actions in V Team Central if needed.
- Set recurring meetings or calendar reminders to check in on development with your employee.
- Follow up on any action items your employee needs from you to succeed.
- Take detailed notes and track your employee's progress throughout the year.
- Celebrate accomplishments as goals are met and help your employee pivot when needed.

Development throughout the year

Keeping things rolling with your team



This toolkit can be useful to you at any point in the year! It's never too late to start planning for and supporting your team's development.

But what do you do after you've made it to the end?

Development is at its best when you build it into your day to day and continue focusing on it throughout the year. Use the following tips to keep things rolling as you and your team learn and grow!

Keep it going

Keep your employee's development front and center throughout the year by following these simple tips!

1. **Set a regular cadence for 2+2 conversations** with your employee to discuss progress towards goals and make adjustments throughout the year. *
2. **Encourage your employee to set time on their calendar monthly to revisit development.**
 - Reflection questions: How are you progressing against your goals? Do you need support or guidance on any of your Development Actions?
3. **Celebrate your employee's progress!** When your employee completes a Development Action, celebrate the achievement and congratulate them on taking time to invest in themselves! Remind them that they should **add any new skills to their career profile.**
4. **Provide timely and regular feedback!** No need to wait until a formal conversation. Feedback works best when it's in the moment!

*2+2 Conversations are not applicable to associates

How to keep development conversations going with 2+2s



2+2 Conversations are opportunities to step back from your day-to-day work and have a conversation about your progress towards performance and development goals.

Share with your employee:

- two comments on progress towards performance or development goals and
- two items your employee should do more or less of to increase performance or advance development moving forward.

Download a template to help you prep or start your 2+2 now!

2+2 Template

Start 2+2

These are moments that matter!

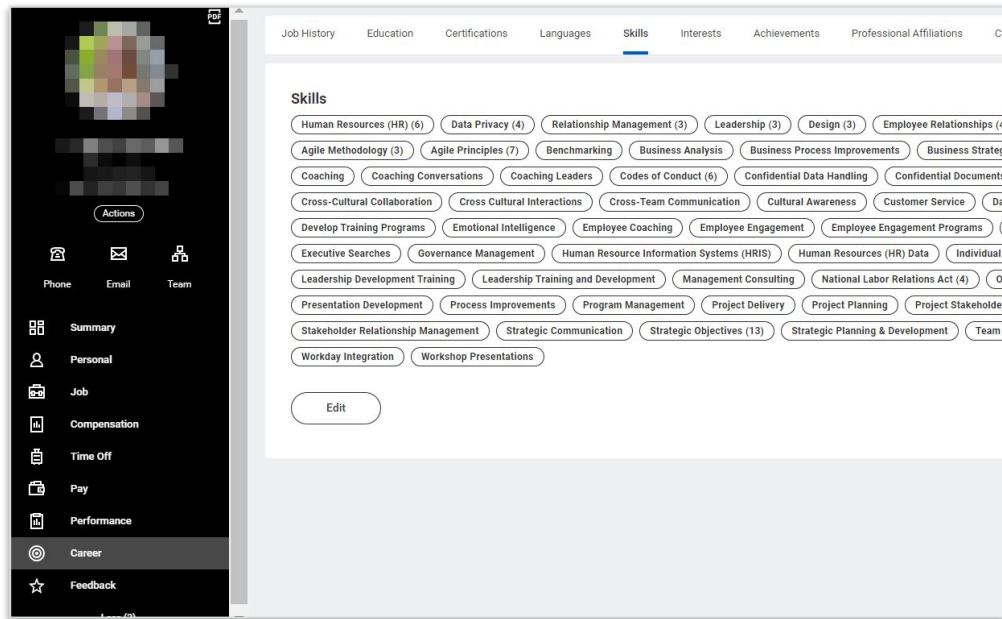
- Be intentional about creating these moments. Set recurring meetings for these conversations and do your best not to move the time.
- Make sure your 2+2s do not turn into 1:1 conversations. Try to avoid talking about day-to-day responsibilities and focus more on the big picture.
- No need to wait for a 2+2! Give timely, actionable and constructive feedback as close to “in the moment” as possible and offer support and guidance to help remove obstacles in between your 2+2 Conversations.

*2+2 conversations will be available to myInfo users as well as those using V Team Central for performance processes. 2+2 conversations are not applicable to associates

Make your Career Profile work for you.

Your Career Profile, located in V Team Central, showcases the unique set of experiences and skills you've gained along your career journey.

Keeping your profile up to date will put you in the driver's seat of your career here at Verizon.



Feedback- the key to continuous growth

Feedback

What is constructive feedback?

Feedback aimed at achieving a positive outcome by providing someone with comments, advice, or suggestions that are actionable and useful for their work or their future.

Why is feedback important?

- Creates more meaningful relationships
- Decreases workplace conflict
- Sparks greater collaboration and innovation
- Establishes a positive work environment
- Fosters learning and agility
- Increases employee engagement
- Improves employee retention - through recognition and development
- Builds greater alignment with company goals

Quality performance and development feedback is **directly correlated** to employee engagement.

Gallup has found that regular feedback can **increase motivation** to do outstanding work by as much as **3.2x** and **being engaged** at work by up to **2.7x**.

Getting feedback on my team

You provide great insight and feedback to your team members in 2+2s and Performance Reviews but sometimes **it's good to get a different perspective.**

In V Team Central, you can now **request developmental feedback** from colleagues on each of your team members, or employees can also request feedback for their own development!

This feedback in V Team Central **should be used as part of development planning** and not an input to performance reviews.

Get Feedback on your team now by clicking the icon.



* This feedback functionality does not apply to associates.

The screenshot displays the V Team Central feedback interface. It features two identical question prompts, each with a text input field and a 'Decline' checkbox. The first question asks, 'What does this person do well that should be continued? Please provide specific examples.' The second question asks, 'What could this person start doing to be more effective? Please provide specific examples.' Below these questions is a 'Process History' section showing a status of 'Give Requested Feedback- Awaiting Action' with a due date of 'Due 05/01/2023'. At the bottom, there are four buttons: 'Submit', 'Save for Later', 'Decline All', and 'Cancel'.

Using Feedback for Development



What does it mean to use V Team Central Feedback for development?

Stakeholders, peers, and other employees can provide valuable feedback to support your employee's development. However, when it comes to giving feedback on performance, as the manager you are best positioned to provide this performance feedback as other stakeholders may have varying levels of exposure and varying priorities.

Given that, feedback received through the Feedback tool in V Team Central should be discussed by you and your employee as part of their development planning conversations. It can help you and your employee identify areas for them to focus on for their development goals or areas to continue to build skills in.

V Team Central Feedback should not be used to solicit feedback that would be taken into account in a Mid-Year or Year-End performance review, or as part of a Performance Improvement Plan.

What if I get Feedback in V Team Central that raises performance concerns?

While V Team Central Feedback should not be used to solicit performance feedback, if there is a performance concern that is raised in the feedback provided, please consult with your HR Business Partner on the appropriate way to address this.

* The feedback functionality in V Team Central does not apply to associates.

Take some time to learn about feedback

Click on the boxes below to learn more! 



Feedback Best Practices

Verizon is committed to creating a culture of continuous feedback and you can help us get there! Check out our Feedback Best Practices to learn more and to skill up so you can give (and receive!) feedback like a pro.

Giving & Receiving Feedback

These tips will help lead you into a cycle of continuous development that can help propel your career and your relationships forward.

Feedback Is Not Enough

Find out how to go beyond traditional feedback and provide employees with the coaching they need to succeed.





verizon